
COMMUNITY
SUMMIT
Dynamics 365
Business
Central (NAV)
October 11–15, 2026
Gaylord Opryland Resort
Opryland, Nashville
October 11-15, 2026
COMMUNITY
SUMMIT
BUSINESS CENTRAL
SPEAKER
2026

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AL Bootcamp: Build your Foundation

Day 1



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The largest independent Microsoft AI & Business Applications User Conference on the planet.

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Speakers



Brad Prendergast



AJ Ansari

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Brad Prendergast

- 25+ years in Microsoft Dynamics, specializing in Business Central
- Member of Summit Programming Committee & Board of Advisors
- Business Central/NAV All-Star Award
- Co-host of the popular Dynamics Corner podcast
- BusinessCentralTrivia.com



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AJ Ansari

- Community Summit Legend and BCUG All-Star
- 17 years in Microsoft Dynamics; background as certified developer, consultant and practice leader
- Member of Summit Programming Committee & Board of Advisors



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Only BC Fans

Only Copilot Fans

DSWi

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Know Before You Go

- Restrooms are where?
- Nearest Emergency Exit is where?



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Session Objectives

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- Setup a Development Environment
- Understand Business Central Architecture
- Create an extension in Business Central
- Extend Business Central

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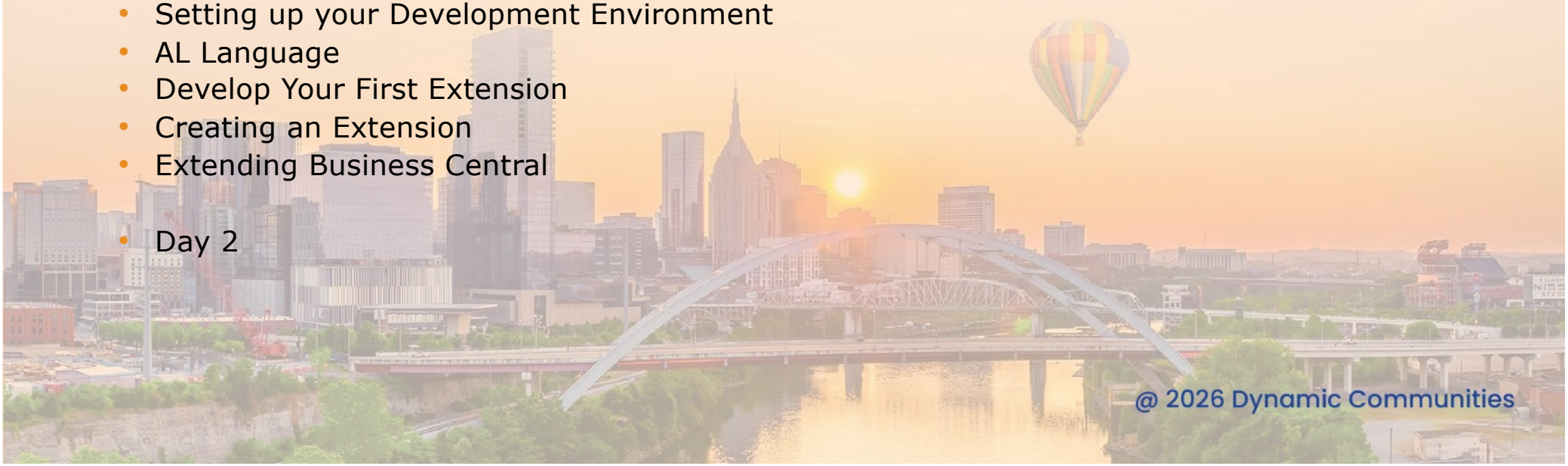
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Agenda

- Day 1
- Introduction
- Getting Started
- Setting up your Development Environment
- AL Language
- Develop Your First Extension
- Creating an Extension
- Extending Business Central

- Day 2



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About You

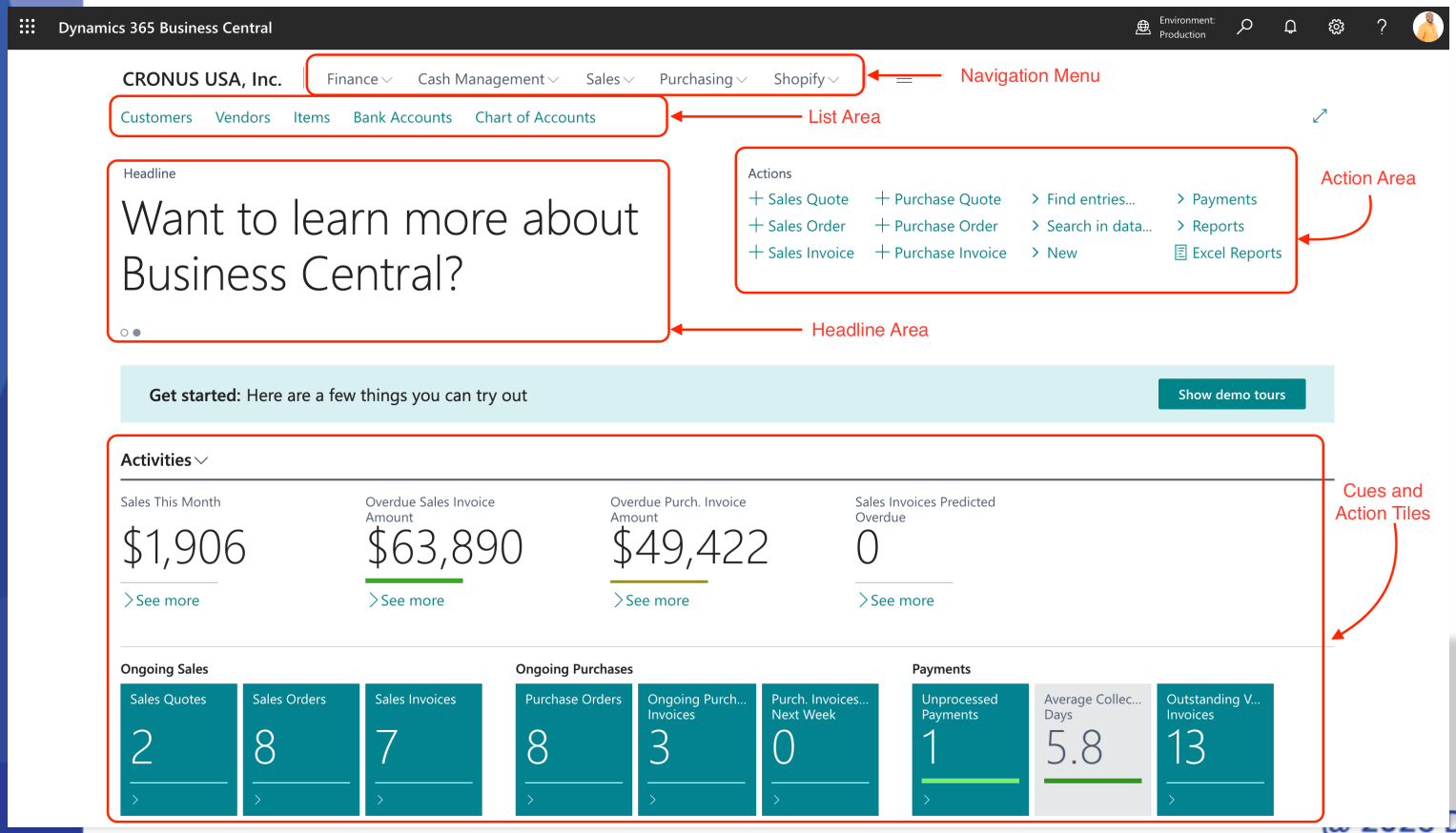
- Name
- Company
- Role
- What are you hoping to learn?

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Getting Started

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Business Central Layout

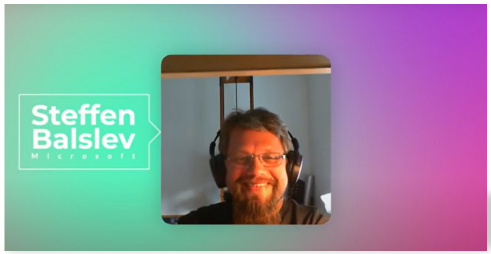


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What is the AL Language?

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- AL is the program language used for Dynamics 365 Business Central; Extension Based Approach
- Origin from C/AL (Client/Server Application Language) for extending Dynamics NAV (along side C/SIDE)
- VS Code Integration
- Transpiler - source-to-source compiler - "translator" and "compiler."
- https://www.dynamicscorner.com/2023/06/episode-220-in-the-dynamics-corner-chair-the-al-compiler-in-depth/



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Personalize vs. Design vs. Develop

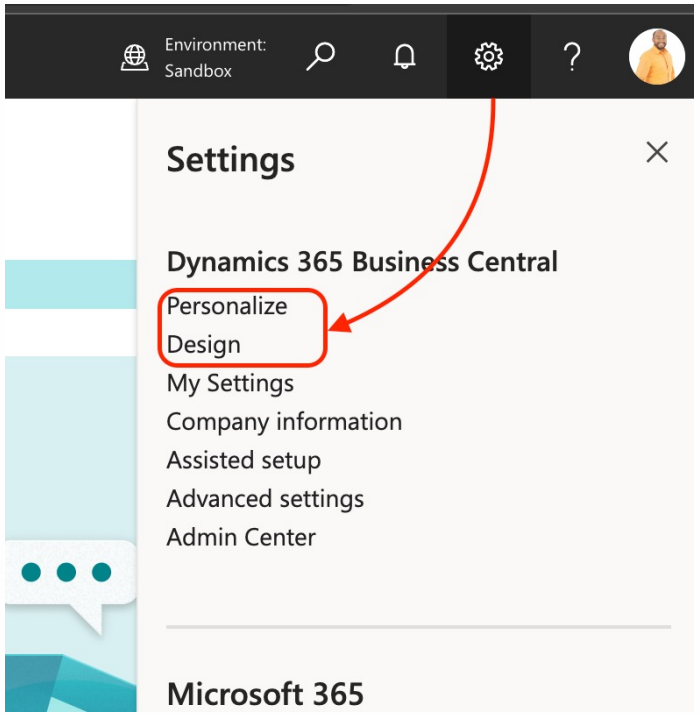
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Personalize

- User Specific
- Limited
- Only Fields Available to Page

Design

- Global
- Creates new Extension as .zip
- Only from Sandbox



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Personalize vs. Design vs. Develop

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Existing Objects

- Tables, Pages, Reports, Enums

Create new objects of any kind

- Page Type: API

BC Online

- Cannot change base objects

BC On-Premises

- Base Objects CAN be modified

https://bit.ly/d365bcuci

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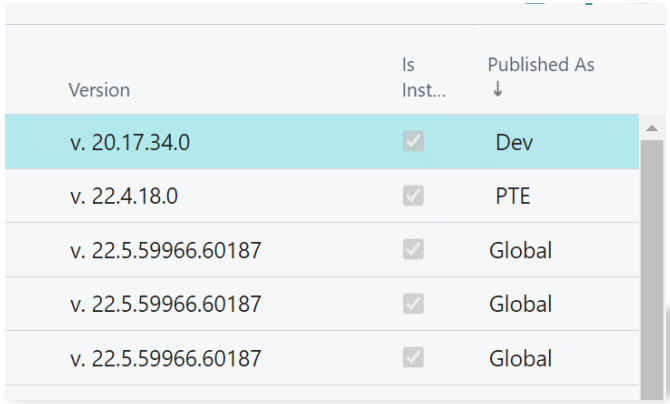
Extension Types

- Global
  - Installed from the AppSource
  - Production and Sandbox
  - Preserved on upgrade for both Production and Sandbox
- Per-tenant (PTE)
  - Installed through Extension Management
  - Specific to environment
  - Production and Sandbox
  - Preserved on upgrade in Production (unless there is a problem)
  - Uninstalled from Sandbox when relocated if dependent on DEV

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Extension Types

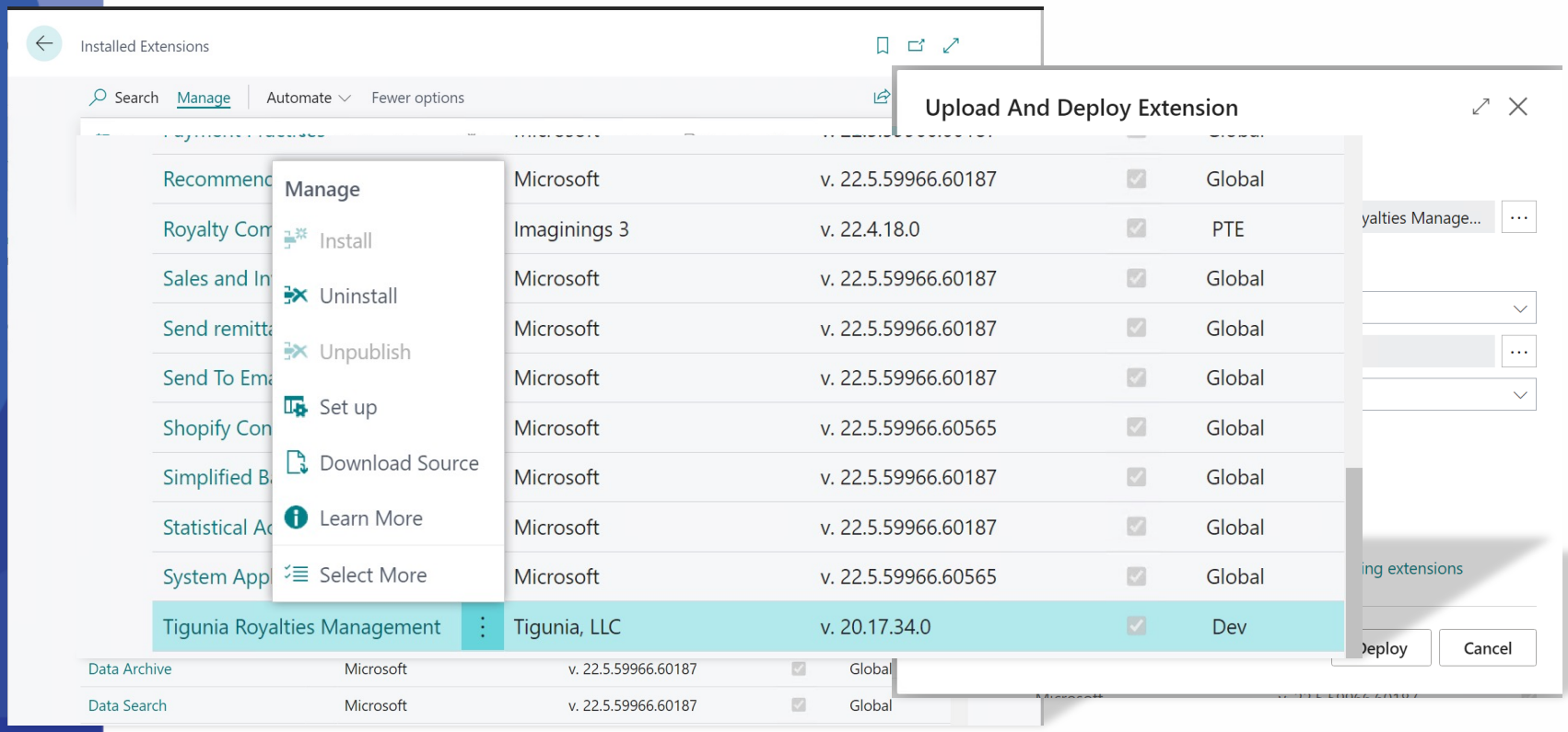
- DEV
  - Published from VS Code
  - Used for development purposes
  - Only exist in Sandbox
  - uninstalled when the sandbox environment is upgraded or relocated (data is not removed)



Version	Is Inst...	Published As ↓
v. 20.17.34.0	☑	Dev
v. 22.4.18.0	☑	PTE
v. 22.5.59966.60187	☑	Global
v. 22.5.59966.60187	☑	Global
v. 22.5.59966.60187	☑	Global

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Extension Management



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Setup Development Environment

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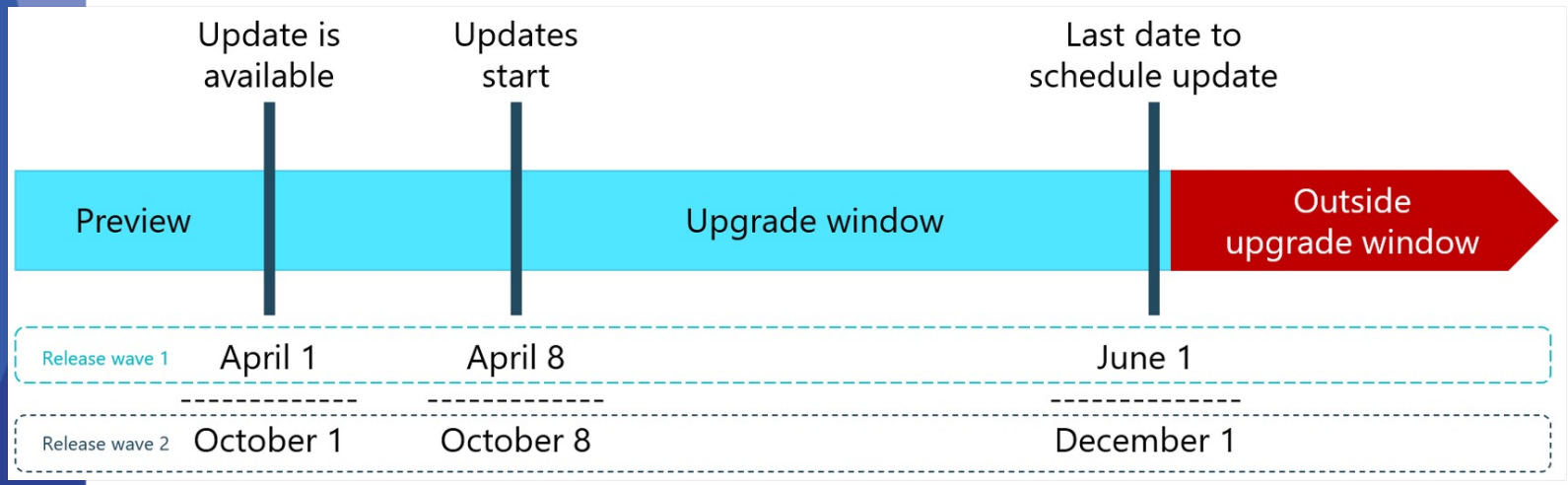
Local Environment

- Visual Studio Code (https://code.visualstudio.com/Download/)
- AL Language Extension
- Other Extensions
  - AZ AL Dev Tools/AL Code Outline
  - Waldo's CRS AL Language Extension
  - Vscode-icons
  - Code Spell Checker
  - Create GUID
- Report Builder (https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/download/details.aspx?id=53613)



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Business Central Tenant



Update Window is still currently at 60 Days

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Business Central Tenant

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- Admin Center
- Create an Environment
  - Environment Types
  - Copy an environment
- Managing Updates
  - Set Update Window
  - Schedule an Update date
  - Get notified of Updates



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Extension Settings

Environment

Workspace

Project

```
{
    "al.incognito": true,
    "al.browser": "Chrome",
    "al.enableCodeAnalysis": true,
    "al.backgroundCodeAnalysis": false,
    "al.incrementalBuild": false,
    "al.codeAnalyzers": [
        "${AppSourceCop}",
        "${CodeCop}",
        "${PerTenantExtensionCop}",
        "${UICop}"
    ],
    "al.compilationOptions": {
        "generateReportLayout": true
    },
    "alOutline.completionProviders": [
        "VariableNamesWithType",
        "VariableDataTypes"
    ],
    "debug.inlineValues": "on",
    "debug.console.fontFamily": "default",
    "debug.console.fontSize": 14,
```

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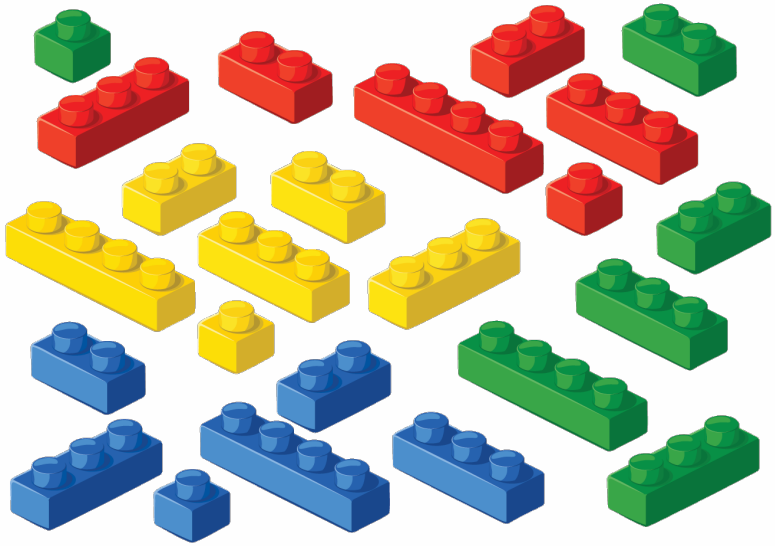
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AL Language

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AL Language

- Objects
  - Table
  - Page
  - Reports
  - Codeunits
  - XMLPorts
  - Query
  - Permissionset



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AL Language - Table

- Tables are the core objects used to store data in Dynamics 365 Business Central

- The structure of a table has four sections:
  - The first block contains metadata for the overall table, such as the table type.
  - The fields section describes the data elements that make up the table, such as their name and the type of data they can store.
  - The keys section contains the definitions of the keys that the table needs to support.
  - The final section details the triggers and code that can run on the table.

```
table 50104 Address
{
    Caption = 'Sample table';
    DataPerCompany = true;

    fields
    {
        field(1; Address; Text[50])
        {
            Description = 'Address retrieved by Service';
        }
        field(2; Locality; Text[30])
        {
            Description = 'Locality retrieved by Service';
        }
        field(3; "Town/City"; Text[30])
        {
            Description = 'Town/City retrieved by Service';
        }
        field(4; County; Text[30])
        {
            Description = 'County retrieved by Service';

            trigger OnValidate();
            begin
                ValidateCounty(County);
            end;

        }
    }
    keys
    {
        key(PrimaryKey; Address)
        {
            Clustered = TRUE;
        }
    }

    var
        Msg: Label 'Hello from my method';

    trigger OnInsert();
    begin

    end;

    procedure MyMethod();
    begin
        Message(Msg);
    end;
}
```

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AL Language - Page

- Pages are the main way to display and organize visual data in Dynamics 365 Business Central.
- The structure of a table has four sections:
  - The first block contains metadata for the overall page; the type of the page and the source table it is showing data from.
  - The next section; the layout, describes the visual parts on the page.
  - The final section details the actions that are published on the page.

```
page 50101 SimpleCustomerCard
{
    PageType = Card;
    SourceTable = Customer;
    ContextSensitiveHelpPage = 'my-feature';

    layout
    {
        area(content)
        {
            group(General)
            {
                field("No."; "No.")
                {
                    ApplicationArea = All;
                    CaptionML = ENU = 'Hello';

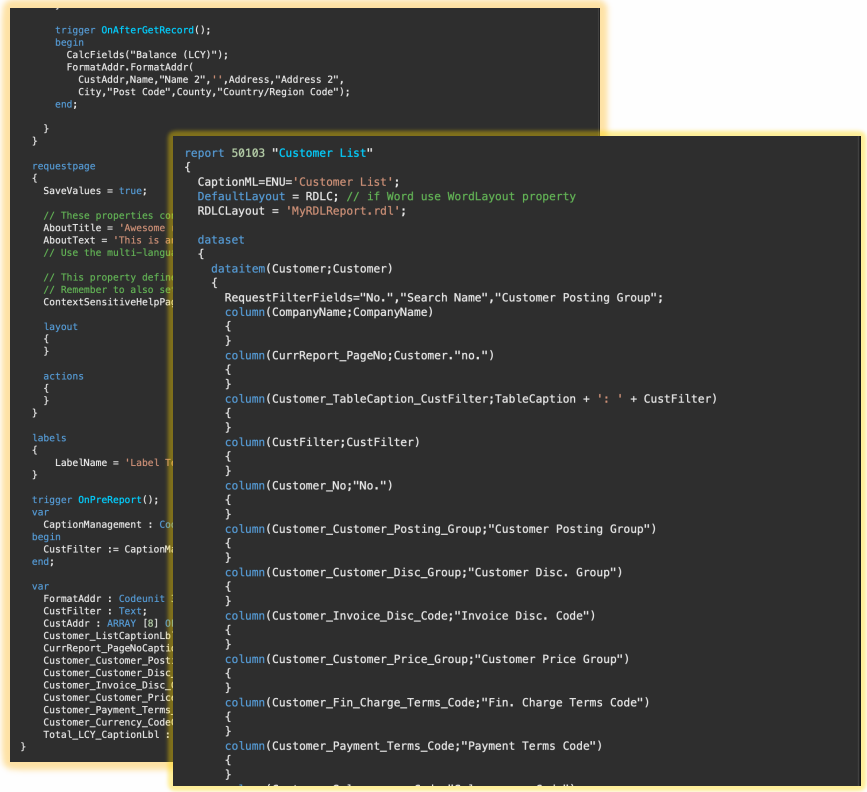
                    trigger OnValidate()
                    begin
                        if "No." < '' then
                            Message('Number too small')
                    end;
                }

                field(Name; Name)
                {
                    ApplicationArea = All;
                }
                field(Address; Address)
                {
                    ApplicationArea = All;
                }
            }
        }
    }
    actions
    {
        area(Navigation)
        {
            action(NewAction)
            {
                ApplicationArea = All;
                RunObject = codeunit "Document Totals";
            }
        }
    }
}
```

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AL Language - Report

- Reports are used to print or display information*
- Reports consist of a data model and layout
- A report object consists of four sections
  - The first block contains metadata for the overall table
  - The second block is the dataset that defines the data model
  - The third section is the request page for accepting user input
  - The final section details the triggers and code that can run on the report



* processing reports; Excel download; Excel Layouts

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AL Language - Codeunit

- Modularized container for AL Code that contains business logic.
- Procedures, Variables, Event Subscribers
- The Access property defines the scope of the codeunit - public or internal.

```
codeunit 50100 MyCodeunit
{
    Access = Public;
    Subtype = Normal;

    trigger OnRun()
    begin

    end;

    procedure MyFunction(Param1: Integer; Param2: Text[50]) : Boolean
    begin

    end;
}
```

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AL Language - XMLPort

- Export and Import data between an external source and Dynamics 365 Business Central
- XML Document
- Variable or Fixed Text Format
- Direction – Inbound, Outbound



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AL Language - Query

- Retrieve records from one or more tables and then combine the data into rows and columns in a single dataset
- Two Types - Normal and API
- dataitems and columns
- SqlJoinType Property

```
query ID Name
{

    elements
    {
        dataitem(DataItem1; Table1)
        {
            column(Column1; Field1)
            {
            }
            column(Column2; Field2)
            {
            }
            dataitem(DataItem2; Table2)
            {
                // Sets a link between FieldY of Table2 and FieldX of Table1.
                DataItemLink = FieldY = DataItem1.FieldX;
                //The dataset contains records from Table1 and Table2 where a match is found betweer
                SqlJoinType = InnerJoin;

                column(Column1; Field1)
                {
                }
                dataitem(DataItem3; Table3)
                {
                    DataItemLink = FieldZ = DataItem2.FieldY;
                    SqlJoinType = InnerJoin;
                    column(Column1; Field1)
                    {
                    }
                }
            }
        }
    }
}
```

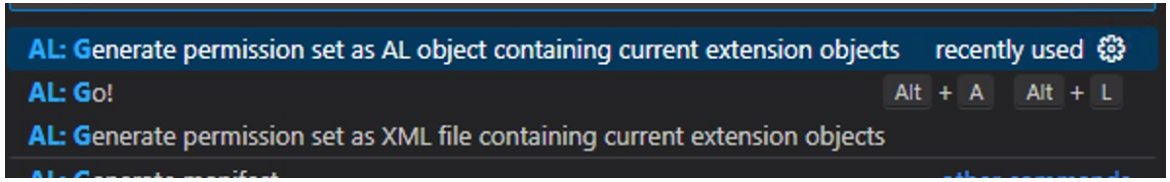
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AL Language – PermissionSet

- Describes permissions on objects
- Assignable to users in Business Central
- Extended permission sets are additive

```
permissionset 50134 "Sales Person"
{
    Assignable = true;
    Caption = 'Sales Person';

    Permissions =
        tabledata Customer = RIMD,
        tabledata "Payment Terms" = RMD,
        tabledata Currency = RM,
        tabledata "Sales Header" = RIM,
        tabledata "Sales Line" = RIMD;
}
```

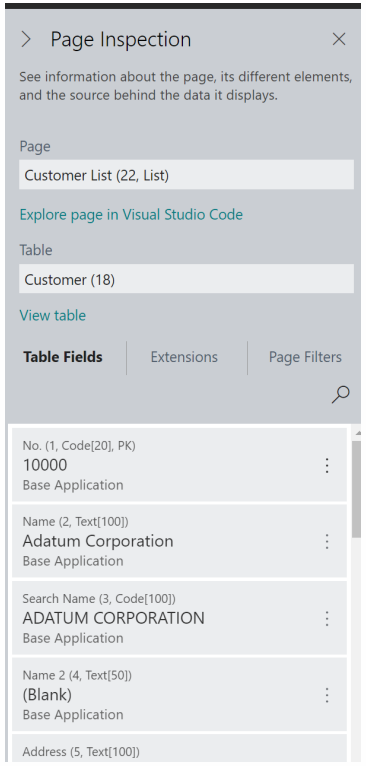


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Page Inspector

- insight into the page design
- different page elements
- source behind the data

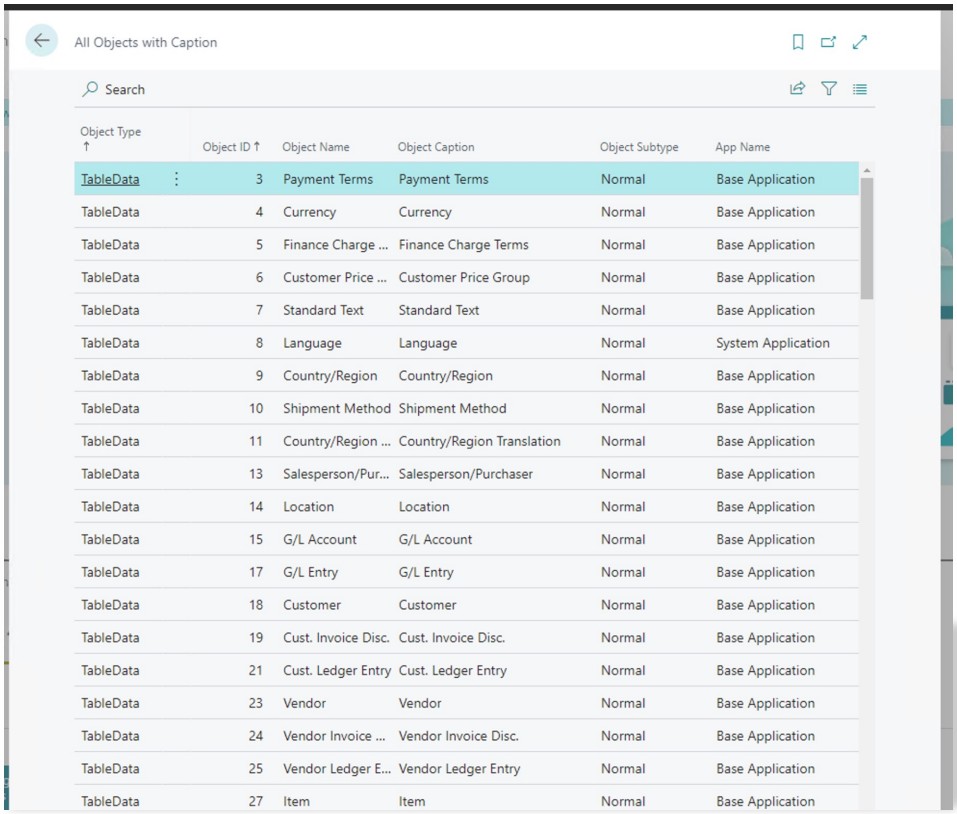
Ctrl + Alt + F1.





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All Objects

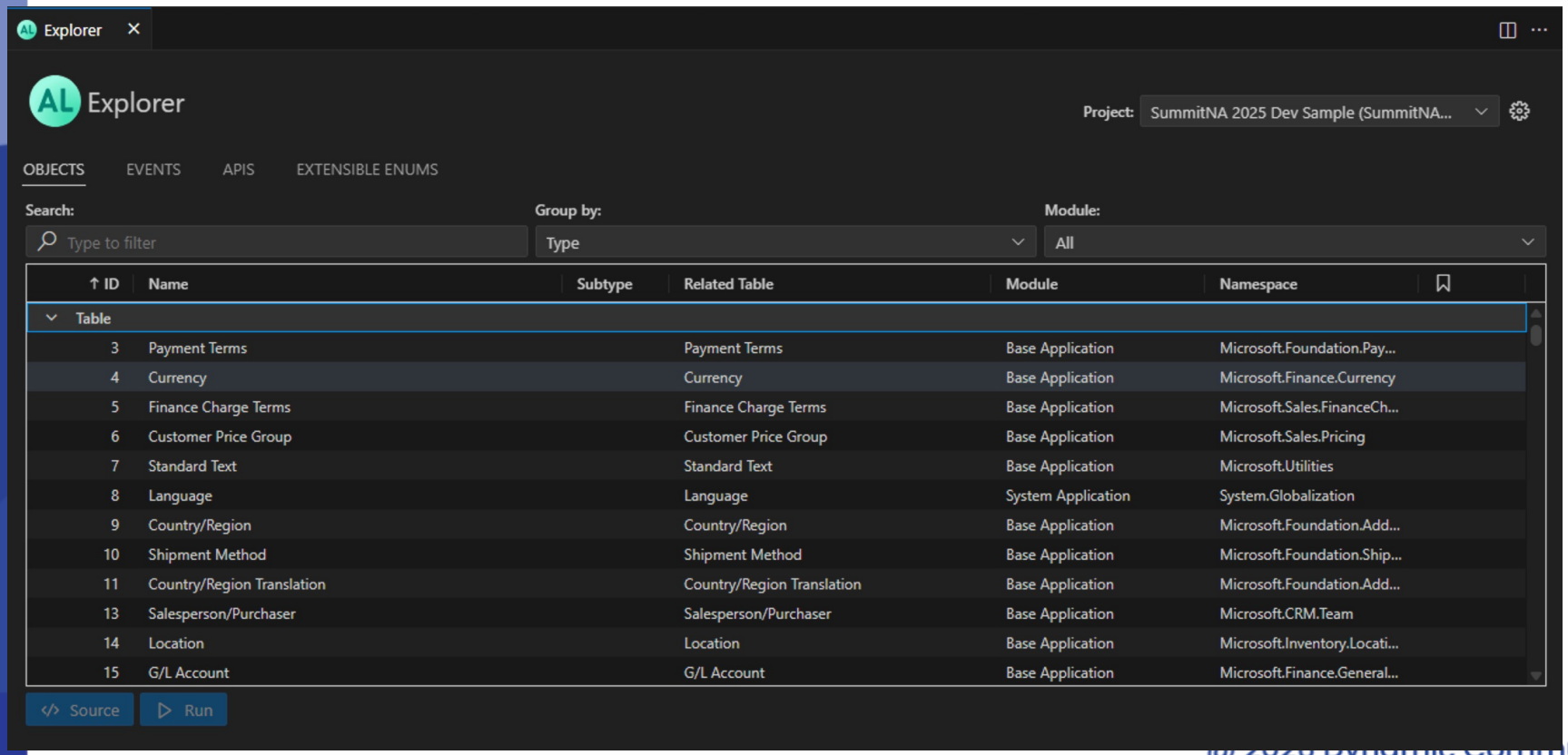


Object Type	Object ID	Object Name	Object Caption	Object Subtype	App Name
TableData	3	Payment Terms	Payment Terms	Normal	Base Application
TableData	4	Currency	Currency	Normal	Base Application
TableData	5	Finance Charge ...	Finance Charge Terms	Normal	Base Application
TableData	6	Customer Price ...	Customer Price Group	Normal	Base Application
TableData	7	Standard Text	Standard Text	Normal	Base Application
TableData	8	Language	Language	Normal	System Application
TableData	9	Country/Region	Country/Region	Normal	Base Application
TableData	10	Shipment Method	Shipment Method	Normal	Base Application
TableData	11	Country/Region ...	Country/Region Translation	Normal	Base Application
TableData	13	Salesperson/Pur...	Salesperson/Purchaser	Normal	Base Application
TableData	14	Location	Location	Normal	Base Application
TableData	15	G/L Account	G/L Account	Normal	Base Application
TableData	17	G/L Entry	G/L Entry	Normal	Base Application
TableData	18	Customer	Customer	Normal	Base Application
TableData	19	Cust. Invoice Disc.	Cust. Invoice Disc.	Normal	Base Application
TableData	21	Cust. Ledger Entry	Cust. Ledger Entry	Normal	Base Application
TableData	23	Vendor	Vendor	Normal	Base Application
TableData	24	Vendor Invoice ...	Vendor Invoice Disc.	Normal	Base Application
TableData	25	Vendor Ledger E...	Vendor Ledger Entry	Normal	Base Application
TableData	27	Item	Item	Normal	Base Application



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AL Explorer



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Lunch ?!?

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Develop your first App

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Develop your First App

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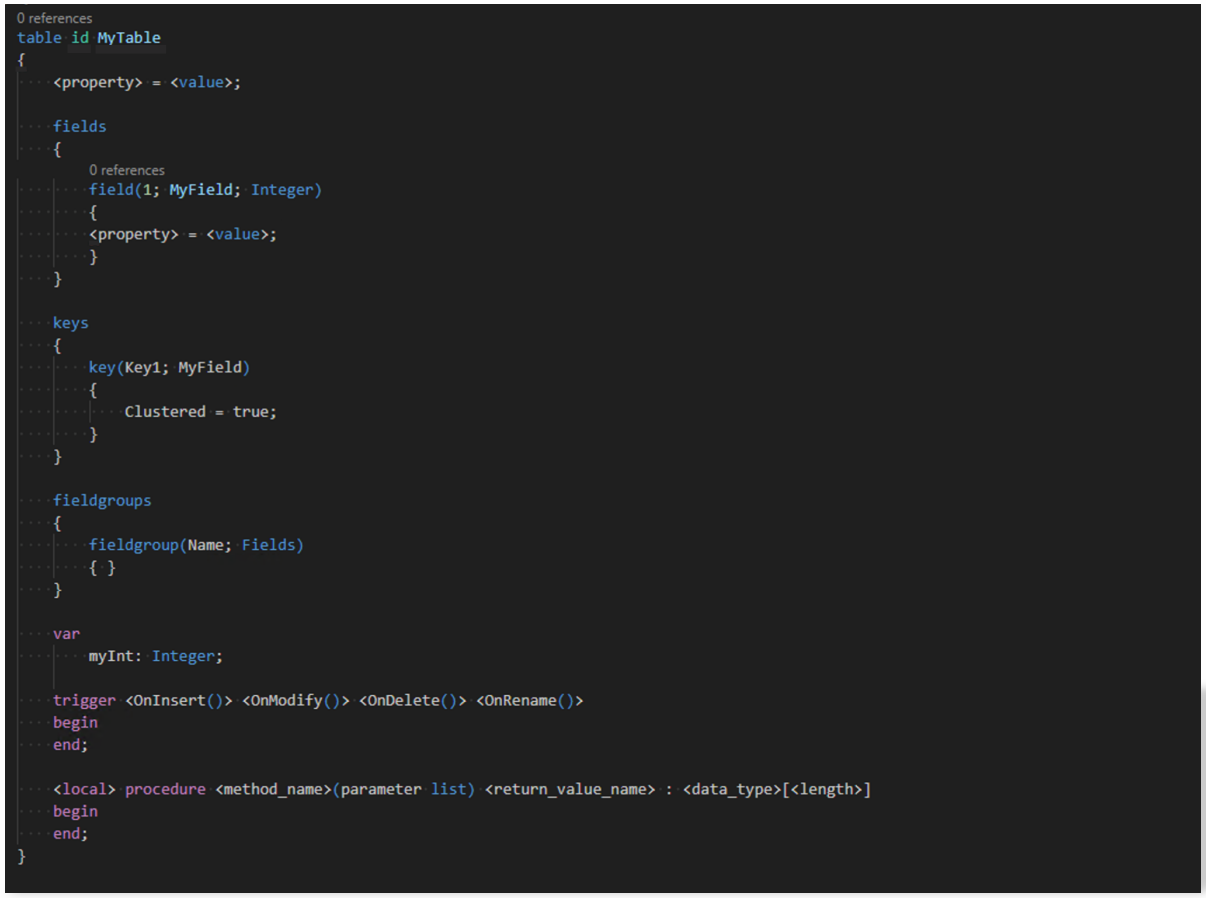
- AL Go!
- Download Symbols
- Publish
- Project Files
- AL Home
- AL Explorer
- Source Code Analyzers

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Development

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Development - Tables



```
0 references
table id MyTable
{
    <property> = <value>;

    fields
    {
        0 references
        field(1; MyField; Integer)
        {
        <property> = <value>;
        }
    }

    keys
    {
        key(Key1; MyField)
        {
            Clustered = true;
        }
    }

    fieldgroups
    {
        fieldgroup(Name; Fields)
        { }
    }

    var
        myInt: Integer;

    trigger <OnInsert()> <OnModify()> <OnDelete()> <OnRename()>
    begin
    end;

    <local> procedure <method_name>(parameter list) <return_value_name> : <data_type>[<length>]
    begin
    end;
}
```

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Development

- Assignment Statements
- Control Statements
- Repetitive Statements

```
procedure assignments()
var
    item: Record Item;
    itemNo: Code[20];
    price: Decimal;
    counter: Integer;
    i: Integer;
    color: Text;

begin
    ItemNo := '1000';
    Item.Get(ItemNo);
    Counter := 1;

    if counter > 1 then begin
        price := Item."Unit Price" * Counter;
    end else begin
        price := Item."Unit Price";
    end;

    for i := 1 to 10 do begin
        counter += 1;
    end;

    while counter > 0 do begin
        counter -= 1;
    end;

    repeat
        counter += 1;
    until counter >= 10;

    case color of
        'blue':
            Message('blue');
        'black':
            Message('black');
        'green':
            Message('green');
        else
            Message('no color');
    end;
end;
```

Development - Pages

```
page Id MyPage
{
    PageType = Card;
    ApplicationArea = All;
    UsageCategory = Administration;
    SourceTable = TableName;

    layout
    {
        0 references
        area(Content)
        {
            0 references
            group(GroupName)
            {
                0 references
                field(Name; NameSource)
                {
                    ApplicationArea = All;

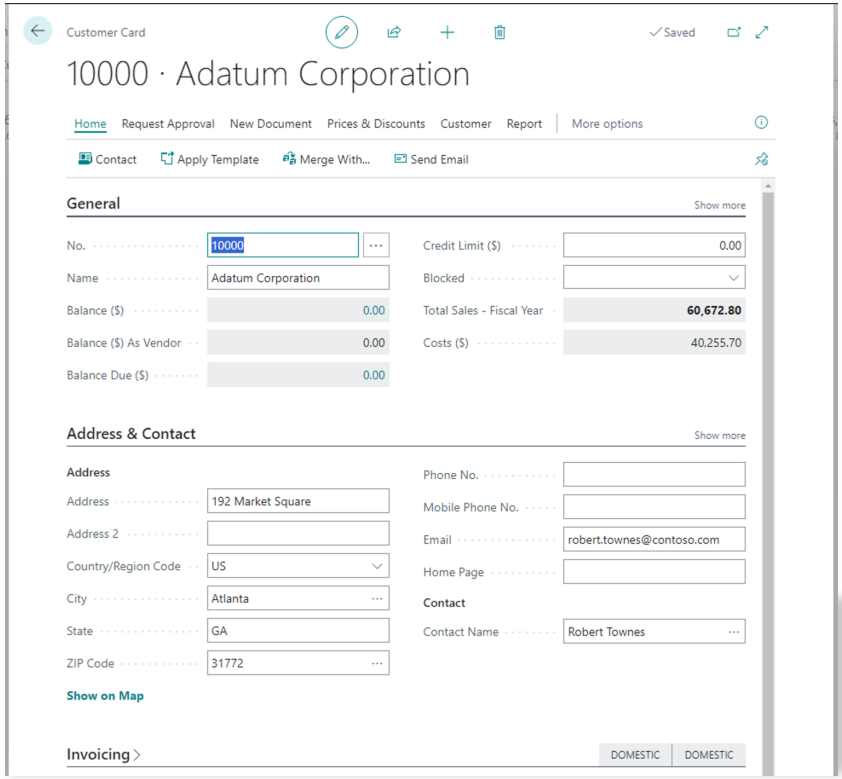
                }
            }
        }
    }

    actions
    {
        0 references
        area(Processing)
        {
            0 references
            action(ActionName)
            {
                ApplicationArea = All;

                0 references
                trigger OnAction()
                begin

                end;
            }
        }
    }

    var
        0 references
        myInt: Integer;
}
```



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Development - Pages

Page type	Examples of use	Main data display
RoleCenter	Overview of business performance and the start page for a specific user profile.	Defined by the embedded parts.
Card	Master, reference, and set up data management. Card page example	Single entity
Document	Transaction and other document management.	Single entity
ListPlus	Statistics, details, and related data management.	Single entity
List	Entity overviews and navigation, and inline editing of simple entities. List page example	Collection of entities/entries
Worksheet	Line-based data entry tasks (such as journals) and inquiries.	Collection of entities
CardPart	A page that is embedded in another page, such as in a FactBox.	Single entity
ListPart	A page that is embedded in another page, such as in a FactBox.	Collection of entities/entries



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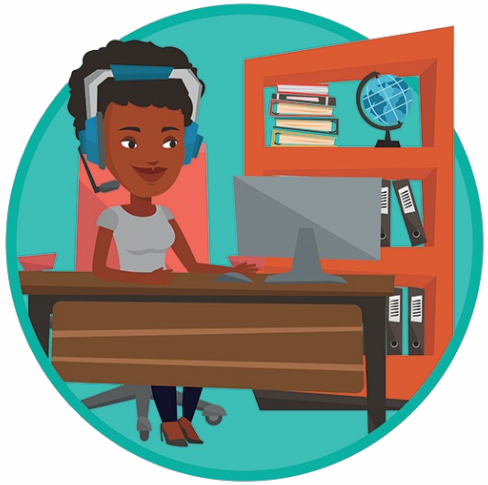
Exercise 1

The Contoso Training and Events (CTE) company would like the ability to capture Instructor profile.

They need to be able to capture detail information regarding the instructor. CTE would like to capture an instructor ID, Name, Type, and contact details.

They would also like to be able to list Training and Events Sessions that contains the session ID, Name or description, capacity, Type, and if possible, start and end date.

Then create a location for where those sessions will be held.



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Development

- Table Relations - Sets up a lookup into another table

```
TableRelation = <TableName>[.<FieldName>] [WHERE(<TableFilters>)] |
[IF(<Conditions>) <TableName>[.<FieldName>] [WHERE(<TableFilters>)] ELSE <TableRelation>]
<Conditions> ::= <TableFilters>
<TableFilters>::= <TableFilter> {,<TableFilter>}
<TableFilter>::= <DestinationFieldName>=CONST(<FieldConst>) | FIELD(<SourceFieldName>)
```

```
field(5; "Instructor No."; Code[20])
{
    Caption = 'Instructor No.';
    TableRelation = "DEV Instructor"."No.";
}
```

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Development

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- Enumerations – set of named constants

```
enum 50101 "DEV Program Level"
{
    Extensible = true;

    0 references
    value(0; "Beginner")
    {
        Caption = 'Beginner';
    }
    0 references
    value(1; Intermediate)
    {
        Caption = 'Intermediate';
    }
    0 references
    value(2; Advanced)
    {
        Caption = 'Advanced';
    }
}
```

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Development

- PageParts

```
part(SalesLines; "DEV Registration Subform")
{
    ApplicationArea = Basic, Suite;

    SubPageLink = "Registration No." = field("No.");
    UpdatePropagation = Both;
}
```

- PageActions

```
action(Instructors)
{
    ApplicationArea = Basic, Suite;
    Caption = 'Instructors';
    Image = Resource;
    RunObject = page "DEV Session Instructors";
    RunPageLink = "Session No." = field("No.");
    ToolTip = 'View or edit the instructors for this session.';

    0 references
    trigger OnAction()
    begin
        InstructorList.Run();
    end;
}
```



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Exercise 2



The Contoso Training and Events (CTE) company would like to extend the functionality beyond just managing the instructor profiles into a page that shows what sessions the instructors are assigned to.

Contoso would like to be able to capture registrations that contains the session and Contact/Attendees. Create a page and subpage.

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